

Report

1. Introduction

This report presents a detailed performance analysis of an IPL match between **Sunrisers Hyderabad (SRH)** and **Rajasthan Royals (RR)**. The objective is to extract **high-impact insights** from player and team data that can assist coaches, players, and analysts in making informed decisions for future matches.

The analysis focuses on key aspects such as:

- Batting and bowling patterns,
- Performance Under Pressure,
- Analysis of Scoring Patterns & Shot Selection,
- Pitch length usage,
- Extras conceded,
- Fielding efficiency.

By translating these observations into actionable recommendations, this report aims to support the coaching staff in designing better **training programs, match strategies, and performance tracking systems**.

This assignment is part of the **onboarding process for the Performance Analytics Intern – Cricket** role at Ball2Data and mirrors the real-world tasks expected from analytics professionals in high-performance sports environments.

2. Match Overview

Match: Sunrisers Hyderabad vs Rajasthan Royals

Venue: Rajiv Gandhi International Stadium, Uppal, Hyderabad

In a high-scoring encounter during the TATA IPL 2025 season Match No.2, Sunrisers Hyderabad secured a decisive victory over Rajasthan Royals by a margin of 44 runs.

After losing the toss and being put into bat first, Sunrisers Hyderabad posted a high score total of **286/6** in 20 overs. In response, Rajasthan Royals put up a strong fight but were unable to meet the steep target, finishing their innings at **242/6**.

Match Details

- **Toss:** Rajasthan Royals won the toss and elected to field.
- **Result:** Sunrisers Hyderabad won by 44 runs.
- **Player of the Match:** **Ishan Kishan (SRH)** was awarded the Player of the Match for his exceptional performance with bat by scoring first century of the TATA IPL 2025 season

Final Scores

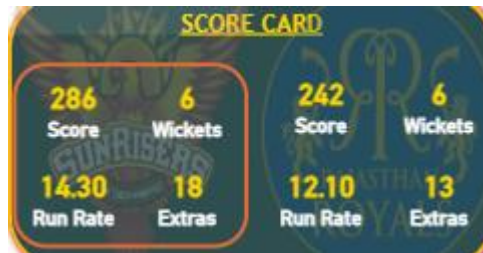


Figure 2.1. Final Innings Scores and Key Statistics

Match Officials

- **Umpires:** Adrian Holdstock, Akshay Totre
- **Third Umpire:** Rohan Pandit
- **Referee:** Shakti Singh

Overall Match Statistics

- **Boundaries:** A total of 51 fours and 30 sixes were hit.
- **Boundary Percentage:** 77.26% of runs came from boundaries.
- **Dot Ball Percentage:** 24.05% of the deliveries were dot balls.
- **Catching Efficiency:** The fielding sides achieved a catching efficiency of 80.00%.

3. Batting Analysis

This analysis takes a deep dive into the batting performances of both teams. Sunrisers Hyderabad held the clear upper hand, securing their victory by a 44-run margin.

The major finding is that SRH's win was built on the foundation laid by their top order. Their aggressive start resulted in a remarkably low dot ball percentage (18.05%), which allowed them to consistently build pressure and set a formidable target.

Conversely, Rajasthan Royals struggled under the pressure of the high required run rate. The loss of wickets at regular intervals prevented them from building momentum, forcing the middle order to shoulder the primary contribution. This struggle is directly reflected in their high dot ball rate of 30.23%, a key factor in their loss.

The following sections break down the key phases, scoring methods, and individual contributions that created this result.

3.1. Combined Match Analysis

3.1.1. Partnership Breakdown

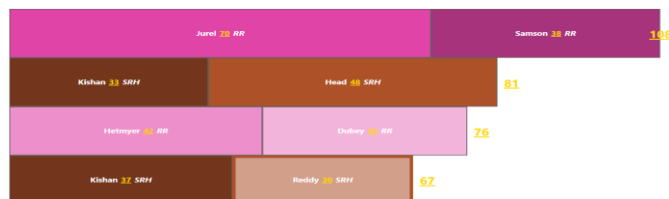


Figure 3.1.1. Partnership Breakdown Stacked Bar Chart

Plot Analysis: The match's largest partnership was a 108-run recovery effort between RR's Jurel and Samson, which came after the loss of three wickets inside the powerplay. In contrast, SRH built their total on a foundation of consistent strong partnerships, ranging from 50 to 81 runs.

Insight: This data reveals a critical difference in batting structure. SRH applied relentless pressure by building multiple, significant partnerships throughout their innings. Rajasthan Royals, having lost early wickets, were forced into a high-pressure consolidation phase and became over-reliant on a single partnership to stay in the match.

3.1.2. Phase-by-Phase Comparison



Figure 3.1.2. Phase-by-Phase Comparison Stacked Column Chart

Plot Analysis: Sunrisers Hyderabad outscored Rajasthan Royals in all three phases of the innings: Powerplay (94 vs. 77), Middle Overs (114 vs. 92), and Death Overs (78 vs. 73).

Insight: This phase-by-phase dominance was the cornerstone of SRH's victory. By consistently building their lead in every segment of the game, they never allowed Rajasthan Royals an opportunity to seize momentum. The 22-run advantage gained in the middle overs proved to be a decisive blow that created too large a gap for the death-over chase.

3.1.3. Scoring Analysis by Shot Type

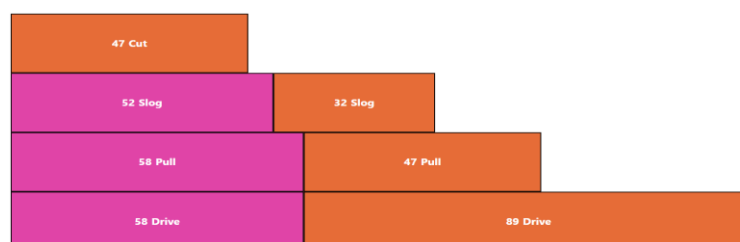


Figure 3.1.3. Scoring Analysis by Shot Type Stacked Bar Chart

- **Plot Analysis:** SRH's scoring was led by the Drive (89 runs), followed by the Pull with 313.33 strike rate and Cut (both 47 runs). In contrast, RR relied heavily on cross-batted power shots, leading with the Pull (58 runs) and Slog (52 runs).
- **Insight:** This data reveals a fascinating tactical battle. Having seen their own batsmen succeed by punishing width with Drives and Cuts, SRH's bowlers appeared to execute a deliberate plan in the second innings. Instead of offering width and pace, they consistently bowled on a hard length and slow balls, inviting the RR batsmen to play their preferred pull shot.

This created a high-risk, high-reward scenario. While Rajasthan Royals did score 58 runs with the pull, the data shows they also lost **three crucial wickets** attempting this exact shot. This suggests SRH made a calculated gamble: they were willing to concede some boundaries on the pull, knowing it was also their most likely source of game-changing wickets. This tactical plan was a key factor in their victory.

3.1.4. Innings Progression Comparison

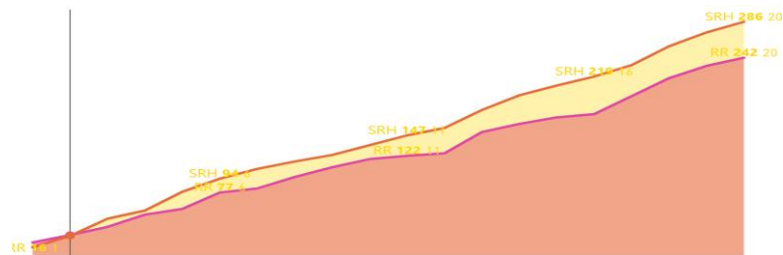


Figure 3.1.4. Innings Progression Comparison line chart

- **Plot Analysis:** The scoring gap between SRH and RR began to widen significantly after the 6-over mark. From that point, SRH consistently stayed ahead of the required rate, never allowing RR to close the distance.
- **Insight:** This chart clearly illustrates the game's critical turning point: the transition from the Powerplay into the Middle Overs. Having already lost three wickets, Rajasthan Royals were forced to use this period for consolidation and partnership building. Their priority shifted from attacking to stabilizing the innings. As a direct consequence, while they successfully built a partnership, their run rate could not keep pace with SRH's. This caused the required run rate to climb steeply, creating immense and ultimately insurmountable pressure on their finishers.

3.2. Team Deep Dive: Rajasthan Royals

3.2.1. RR's Run Contribution by Order

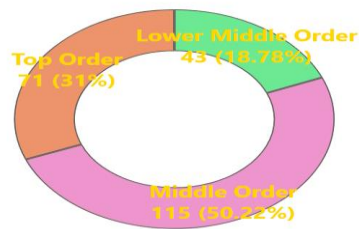


Figure 3.2.1. RR's Run Contribution by Order Donut Chart

- **Plot Analysis::** An unusually high 50.22% of RR's runs (115) came from their middle order, while the top order contributed only 31% (71 runs).
- **Insight:** The top order collapsed under the immense pressure of chasing a mammoth target. This pressure appears to have forced them into a high-risk, hyper-aggressive strategy from the outset, which ultimately failed, resulting in early wickets and an insufficient contribution of only 71 runs.

This premature collapse left the middle order with the unenviable task of rebuilding the innings. Their focus necessarily shifted from attacking the target to simply preventing a total collapse. As a result, while they successfully built partnerships, they could not score at the required run rate, which is why the middle order's large run total was ultimately not enough to win the match.

3.2.2. RR's Wagon Wheel & Scoring Zones

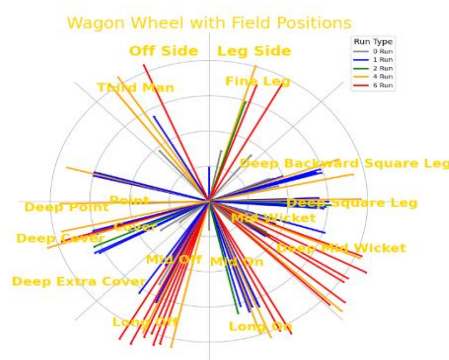


Figure 3.2.2. RR's Wagon Wheel & Scoring Zones

- **Plot Analysis:** The Rajasthan Royals' wagon wheel reveals a clear and predictable scoring pattern. Most of their runs, particularly boundaries, were targeted towards

the leg side, in a wide arc from **Deep Mid-Wicket through Long-on to Deep Square Leg**. There was significantly less scoring activity in the off-side or behind the wicket.

- **Insight:** This wagon wheel provides visual proof of Sunrisers Hyderabad's successful bowling plan. By consistently bowling a disciplined, hard length and avoiding offering width, the SRH bowlers effectively took away the cut and late-cut shots, eliminating scoring options behind the wicket.

This forced the RR batsmen to generate all their power and hit towards the larger, more heavily protected boundaries in front of the wicket. While this strategy still conceded runs, it meant that every boundary attempt was a higher-risk shot, ultimately leading to the key dismissals that derailed RR's chase.

3.3. Team Deep Dive: Sunrisers Hyderabad

3.3.1. SRH's Run Contribution by Order

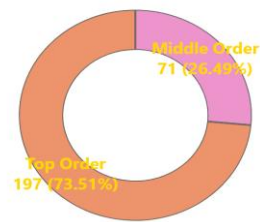


Figure 3.3.1. SRH's Run Contribution by Order Donut Chart

- **Plot Analysis::** SRH executed a perfect T20 batting plan, with their top order scoring a massive **197 runs (73.51%)**.
- **Insight:** This chart reveals that SRH's major success came from contribution of top order which helped them to post a Mammoth target by setting a foundation so strong that the middle order's job is simplified.

3.3.2. SRH's Wagon Wheel & Scoring Zones

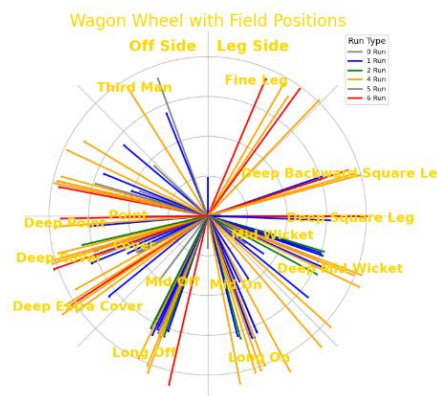


Figure 3.3.2. SRH's Wagon Wheel & Scoring Zones

- **Plot Analysis:** In contrast to Rajasthan Royals, SRH displayed a well-rounded, 360-degree scoring map. They attacked both sides of the field effectively, making them extremely difficult to set fields against.
- **Insight:** The key difference revealed by this chart is SRH's ability to consistently score runs behind the wicket. This proficiency with shots like the cut, late-cut, and ramp allowed them to exploit the shorter boundaries and punish any deliveries that offered even a small amount of width.

3.4. Team Performance Metrics Summary

3.4.1. Sunrisers Hyderabad - Key Metrics



Figure 3.4.1. Sunrisers Hyderabad - Key Metrics

- **Plot Analysis:** SRH paired an extremely low Dot Ball Percentage (18.05%) with a high Boundary Percentage (77.61%).
- **Insight:** This combination of metrics represents the gold standard for a modern T20 batting innings. It highlights a devastatingly effective two-pronged attack:
 - .1. **Explosive Power:** Hitting **46 boundaries** shows they ruthlessly punished any loose deliveries from the opposition.
 - .2. **Relentless Pressure:** The exceptionally low dot ball percentage (18.05%) demonstrates that even when they weren't hitting boundaries, their batsmen were consistently rotating the strike and refusing to waste a single delivery.

3.4.2. Rajasthan Royals - Key Metrics

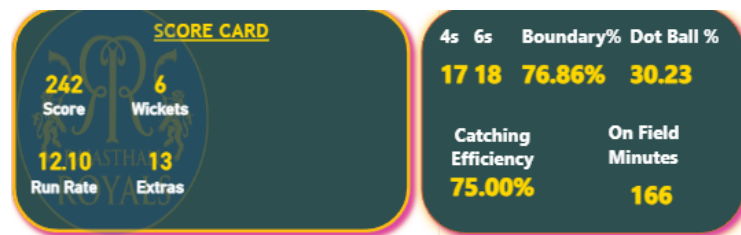


Figure 3.4.2. Rajasthan Royals - Key Metrics

- **Plot Analysis:** Rajasthan Royals failure was came from their Dot Ball Percentage of 30.23%. This means they faced approximately 36 deliveries without scoring—the equivalent of 6 entire overs.
- **Insight:** This metric is not a standalone failure, but rather a symptom of the early damage they sustained. After losing key wickets in the powerplay, their primary objective shifted from aggressively chasing the target to simply consolidating and preventing a full collapse.

This necessary, risk-averse approach during the middle overs is precisely where the dot balls accumulated. Each dot ball not only failed to add to their score but also dramatically increased the required run rate, creating a death-over scenario that was mathematically impossible to overcome

4. Bowling Analysis

This analysis digs into the bowling strategies and execution that determined the match's outcome on a surface known to be a batsman's paradise. The Rajiv Gandhi Stadium pitch, especially in the heat of a 3:30 PM summer start, offers a flat, true surface where a predictable bowling plan is a recipe for disaster. The core finding is that Sunrisers Hyderabad's victory was cemented by their understanding and adaptation to these conditions. They implemented a varied attack that refused damage by prioritizing slower deliveries rather going for pace.

In contrast, Rajasthan Royals bowling effort was defined by a one-dimensional plan that failed to respect the nature of the pitch. Their reliance on standard hard-length deliveries played directly into the batsmen's hands, failing to contain the run flow at any stage of the innings. The following sections break down how one team's adaptability to the conditions led to victory, while the other's rigidity led to defeat.

4.1. Combined Match Analysis

4.1.1. Pace Type vs. Economy and Runs Conceded

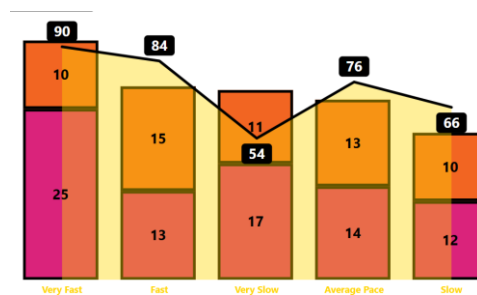


Figure 4.1.1. Pace Type vs. Economy and Runs Conceded Stacked column and line chart

- **Plot Analysis:** The data shows that "Very Fast" (90 runs) and "Fast" (84 runs) bowling were the most expensive pace categories. The "Very Slow" category was the most economical, conceding only 54 runs.
- **Insight:** On a flat Hyderabad pitch with consistent bounce, raw pace without variation becomes predictable and easy for batsmen to line up. This chart proves that fact. The success of slower deliveries indicates that changing the pace and disrupting the batsman's timing was the single most effective tactic on this surface. For Rajasthan Royals, this is a critical insight: their fast bowlers must develop more effective changeups, as pure speed was neutralized and punished by the batting-friendly conditions.

4.1.2. Ball Type vs. Runs Conceded

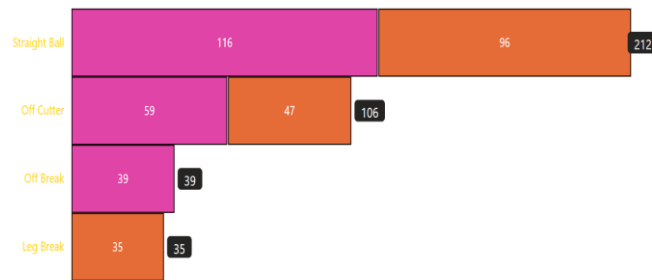


Figure 4.1.2. Ball Type vs. Runs Conceded Stacked Bar Chart

- **Plot Analysis:** The "Straight Ball" was by far the most expensive delivery, conceding 212 runs. Spin deliveries like the "Off Break" (39 runs) and "Leg Break" (35 runs) were highly effective at containing the batsmen.
- **Insight:** This data reinforces the pitch report's characteristics. Standard pace deliveries (Straight Ball) on a flat, true surface offer nothing to challenge the batsman. The success of spin bowling was likely due to the dry, sunbaked afternoon pitch offering some grip and turn—creating a rare element of unpredictability. The bowlers who could get the ball to deviate, either through spin or well-disguised cutters, were the only ones who found success.

4.1.3. Heatmap of Pitching Length & Line



Figure 4.1.3. Heatmap of Pitching Length & Line, Table

- **Plot Analysis:** The heatmap and table shows that deliveries on a traditional "good length" outside off were consistently expensive with **106 runs**. In contrast, the **Yorker on the off stump (3.00 economy)** was the most successful defensive delivery.
- **Insight:** This provides a clear bowling plan to contain batsmen by bowling off stump line and yorker, back of a length. But most of the deliveries bowled at outside off offering runs but got wickets as they thought it as conventional bowling line.

4.2. Team Deep Dive: Rajasthan Royals

4.2.1. Pitch Map - Rajasthan Royals Bowling

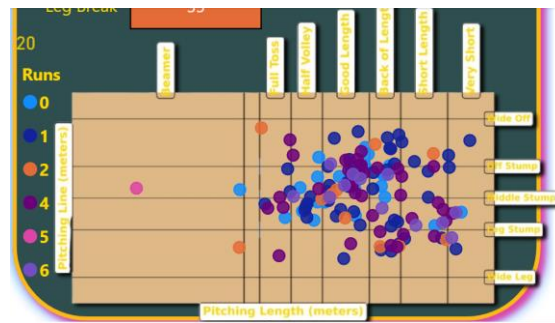


Figure 4.2.1. Pitch Map - Rajasthan Royals Bowling

- **Plot Analysis:** This map shows a predictable and one-dimensional pattern from the RR bowlers. There is a dense cluster of deliveries on a "Good Length" in the off-stump channel, with minimal variation in length or line.
- **Insight:** This visual is a clear representation of a bowling plan that completely failed to adapt to the pitch conditions. RR bowled as if they expected movement or assistance from the surface, which the flat Hyderabad track simply did not offer. As they came under pressure from the constant flow of boundaries, their discipline further eroded. They began to offer even more loose deliveries, which directly explains how the SRH batsmen were able to maintain such a low dot ball percentage and high boundary rate. Instead of adjusting their strategy with variations, they collapsed under pressure and continued with a failing plan.

4.2.2 Pitching Map - Sunrisers Hyderabad Bowling

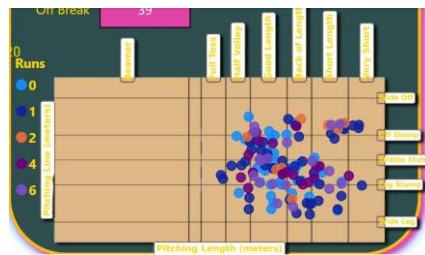


Figure 4.2.2 Pitching Map - Sunrisers Hyderabad Bowling

- **Plot Analysis:** In contrast, the SRH pitch map shows much greater variation, with a wider distribution of lengths, including more **yorkers** and **short balls**.
- **Insight:** This is a masterclass in bowling to the conditions. SRH clearly understood that on a flat, true pitch, the only weapon a bowler has is unpredictability. By constantly changing their lengths and pace, they never allowed the RR batsmen to get comfortable or anticipate the next delivery. They didn't try to fight the pitch; they used tactical variety to out-think the opposition.

5. Fielding & Efficiency Metrics

In a match dominated by batters on a flat Hyderabad pitch, the pressure on the fielding units was immense. This section analyzes the fielding performance, revealing that Sunrisers Hyderabad's superior execution in the field was a subtle but decisive factor in their victory. While both teams faced challenging conditions under the afternoon sun, SRH demonstrated a higher level of concentration and efficiency, converting the rare chances their bowlers created. Rajasthan Royals, in contrast, suffered from critical lapses that proved costly and directly contributed to the imposing total they were forced to chase.

5.1. Sunrisers Hyderabad Metrics

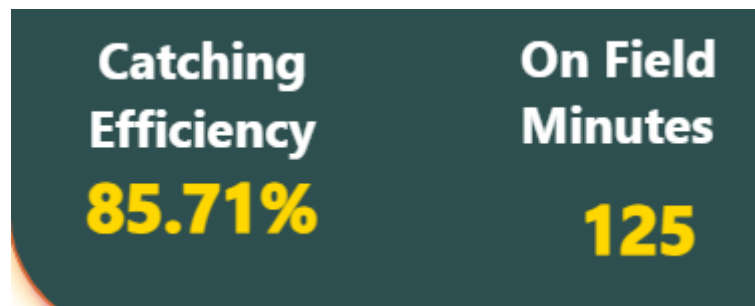


Figure 5.1. Sunrisers Hyderabad Metrics

- **Insight:** An 85.71% catch efficiency in a high-pressure, high-scoring game is the mark of a well-drilled and focused fielding unit. On a flat pitch where bowlers are struggling to create opportunities, converting nearly every chance is paramount. This high percentage indicates that when the RR batsmen made a mistake, the SRH fielders were alert and held their nerve, ensuring the pressure was never released. This clinical execution provided crucial support to their bowlers and was fundamental to defending their total.

5.2 Rajasthan Royals Metrics

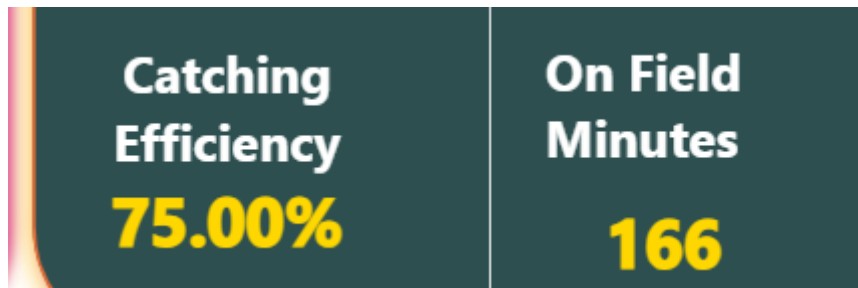


Figure 5.2 Rajasthan Royals Metrics

- **Insight:** A 75% catch efficiency represents a significant underperformance, especially given the context of the match. In the summer heat and with their bowlers under constant attack, every opportunity was a potential turning point. Dropping chances on a batting-friendly surface does more than just add runs to the opposition's total; it demoralizes the bowler and allows set batsmen to inflict even more damage. These lapses in execution directly contributed to the high total they were forced to chase and increased the physical and mental fatigue on the team, as reflected by their longer time on the field (166 minutes).

Conclusion: The 10% difference in catching efficiency between the two teams is not a minor statistic; in a match decided by 44 runs, it represents a significant portion of the winning margin.

6. Conclusion

Sunrisers Hyderabad's decisive 44-run victory was not a simple case of one team out-batting the other; it was a comprehensive triumph built on superior strategy, adaptability, and execution across all three departments of the game. The match, played on a batting-friendly Hyderabad pitch which is home ground of Sunrisers Hyderabad (winning team), served as a masterclass in how to leverage conditions to one's advantage.

The foundation of SRH's win was an explosive yet intelligent batting performance, characterized by a 360-degree attack that scored all around the ground and refused to waste deliveries (18.05% dot balls). This was complemented by a highly adaptable bowling plan that prioritized deception over raw pace, correctly identifying that variation was the only weapon on the flat surface. Finally, their clinical 85.71% catch efficiency ensured that the few opportunities created were converted, sealing the victory.

Conversely, Rajasthan Royals' campaign was a story of a team that failed to adapt. Their bowlers executed a predictable, one-dimensional plan that was ruthlessly punished. This, combined with critical dropped catches (75% efficiency), created an insurmountable target. The pressure of this chase forced their top order into high-risk errors, and while their middle order fought valiantly, the ever-climbing required run rate, fueled by a high dot ball percentage (30.23%), made the task mathematically impossible. In essence, SRH won because they mastered the conditions, while RR was defeated by them.

7. Key Recommendations & Action Plan

This section translates the match analysis into actionable steps for future training and strategy sessions for the team Rajasthan Royals.

For the Batting Unit:

1. **Mandatory Scenario Training for High Chases:** The top order must be drilled in chasing targets above 200. The focus should be on balancing aggressive intent with strike rotation in the powerplay, using the SRH innings as a case study.
2. **Reduce Dot Ball Percentage:** A dot ball rate of over 30% is unacceptable. Implement net sessions where batsmen are penalized for playing more than two consecutive dot balls, forcing them to practice finding singles and twos when boundaries are not an option.
3. **Wagon Wheel Analysis:** Each batsman should review their personal wagon wheel to identify over-reliance on specific zones. Drills should be designed to improve scoring options in their weaker areas.

For the Bowling Unit:

Develop Pre-Match Analysis & In-Game Adaptability: The bowling unit's primary failure was a rigid strategy that collapsed under pressure. The following actions are mandatory:

1. **Pre-Game Opposition Analysis:** Before every match, each bowler must have a clear plan based on video analysis of the opposition batsmen's weak zones. This plan must be documented and reviewed.
2. **Adaptability Under Pressure:** It is unacceptable to default to loose deliveries (full tosses, slot balls) when under pressure. Bowlers must drill high-pressure scenarios to practice executing their "Plan B" (e.g., a slower-ball yorker or a wide-line delivery) instead of losing their discipline.
3. **Intelligence Over Pace:** It must be understood that on flat pitches with good bounce, pure pace is not a weapon; it is a liability. The focus must shift from speed to tactical intelligence—using variations in pace, length, and angle to disrupt timing. Chasing a target like 286 is a near-impossible task, and this score represents a fundamental failure of the bowling unit to execute a disciplined and intelligent plan.

For the Fielding Unit:

1. **Implement High-Pressure Catching Drills:** Catching efficiency must be a primary focus. Drills simulating catches under physical and mental fatigue (e.g., at the very end of a long training session) should be standard practice to replicate match conditions.
2. **Review Fielding Placements:** Analyze the opposition's scoring zones. The SRH bowling plan succeeded because their field was set to support a strategy of forcing high-risk shots to the larger boundaries. Fielding placements must be an active part of the bowling strategy, not a passive default.

